

A Two-Tier Strategy for Public Safety around Banner Lane and Sursum Corda

10 pages | Georgetown University | October 2025 | Not commissioned by the D.C. Council

An academic policy project pairing near-term environmental improvements with longer-term social investment, implementation ownership, and accountability.

PROBLEM

Concentrated neighborhood safety concerns cannot be addressed through policing or redevelopment alone. The memo frames safety as both an immediate environmental challenge and a longer-term problem of opportunity, health, and community capacity.

OPTION ANALYSIS

The paper compares the status quo, Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design alone, and a combined strategy using secondary evidence, place-based problem definition, implementation sequencing, and evaluation planning.

RECOMMENDATION

- Improve lighting, sightlines, maintenance, and greening.
- Pair those measures with youth employment, treatment access, and community violence intervention.

IMPLEMENTATION

The proposed sequence assigns interagency ownership, creates a role for resident guidance, phases near- and longer-term actions, and uses public reporting to make progress and responsibility visible.

EVALUATION AND EQUITY

- Track participation, safety indicators, delivery milestones, and unintended displacement effects.
- Use independent evaluation and transparent reporting to support course correction.

STATUS AND LIMITS

This is a proposed policy strategy, not an implemented intervention or an evaluation of observed Banner Lane outcomes. Local conditions and resident priorities would need current validation before use.

PORTFOLIO NOTE

Coursework structured for a D.C. Council audience. It was not commissioned by, submitted to, or endorsed by the Council.